

Meoncross School History Department

**YEAR 9 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-
2027)**

Teacher Companion Guide

Curriculum Evaluation & Pedagogical Strengths

Strengths & Commendable Practices

Strong Local History Connections

Integrating local context into national and global events serves as a fantastic pedagogical hook. Mentions of the "Fareham ironmaster" in the Industrialisation unit and the profound impact of the "Lost Generation" on the "village of Stubbington" directly ground the history for our pupils. This makes the narrative tangible and relevant to their lived environment, fostering deeper engagement.

Thematic GCSE Preparation

The inclusion of *Water and Sanitation Through Time* acts as an excellent, low-stakes conceptual primer for the Edexcel GCSE *Medicine Through Time* thematic study. It introduces pupils to broad chronology (Roman to Industrial) and core concepts of change, continuity, and significance long before they hit the rigor of GCSE, ensuring a seamless transition.

Solid Chronological Foundation

By correctly sequencing the curriculum to transition from the broad sweep of *Water and Sanitation* directly into *Medieval England (1066-1485)*, pupils gain the vital contextual bedrock (feudalism, Church power, the monarchy) needed to understand the complex religious and power shifts of the Early Modern era.

De-centering the British Narrative

Starting with, or heavily featuring, the *History of Australia* and framing the Early Modern unit as *Global Encounters (1450-1750)* is a very modern, progressive approach. It intentionally moves away from the traditional, purely anglocentric Tudor/Stuart narrative to look critically at the mechanics of early empire, global trade, and the Transatlantic Slave Trade, creating a more diverse and inclusive curriculum.

Deep Dive on World War I

Splitting the Great War into two distinct units (Causes vs. The War) allows for rigorous historical debate (e.g., the Anglo-German naval race, alliance systems). This ensures

pupils aren't just learning the "mud and blood" narrative, but are actively grappling with complex geopolitical causation.

Points for Improvement for 2026/2027

1. Overweighting the 20th Century

Currently, there are two whole units dedicated to the Great War, plus units mapped out for the Second World War, the Shoah, the Cold War, and Post-War Britain. While vital, this risks creating a "modern-heavy" curriculum, sometimes at the expense of early world history.

2. Pre-1450 Global Diversity

The curriculum would benefit from a deep dive into non-European civilizations before European contact. Exploring the Islamic Golden Age, the Mali Empire, or the Silk Roads *before* looking at European "Global Encounters" in 1450 would give pupils a much more balanced view of global history, rather than encountering diverse cultures primarily through the lens of European colonization.

Notice on Year 9 Curriculum Development

Please note that the Year 9 units are currently incomplete. These units (including The Second World War, The Shoah, and The Cold War) will be fully built and mapped out over the next few months to ensure they meet our high pedagogical standards.

Evidence of Impact & Curriculum Mapping

1. Local Context & Coastal Connections

As a coastal school, our curriculum is intentionally designed to root global and national historical events in the maritime geography and lived environment of our pupils.

- **Oceanic Voyages & Penal Colonies:** The Year 8 Australia unit is deeply tied to maritime history, the brutality of ocean voyages, and the establishment of coastal settlements like Botany Bay.
- **Maritime Trade & Naval Dominance:** Our Early Modern World unit explicitly links global power to mastery of the oceans, naval exploration, and control of the Transatlantic Slave Trade.
- **The Anglo-German Naval Race:** The Year 8 Great War unit features a dedicated study on HMS *Dreadnought*, proving how a contest for control of the sea directly sparked global conflict.
- **Local Coastal Impact:** We explicitly study the "Fareham ironmaster" and the impact of the "Lost Generation" on the coastal village of Stubbington, bridging global events with local geography.

2. Historical Skills Progression

Our curriculum ensures rigorous, sequential development of disciplinary thinking from Year 7 through to Year 9, preparing pupils for GCSE demands.

- **Source Utility:** Moves from basic comprehension in Year 7 to evaluating provenance, motive, and audience (e.g., analyzing WWI propaganda and recruitment posters) in Year 8.
- **Historical Interpretations:** Progresses from identifying differing views to critically evaluating opposing academic debates (e.g., assessing modern vs. traditional interpretations of the Magna Carta or the 'Lions led by Donkeys' WWI debate) using contextual knowledge.

- **Argumentation (PEEL):** Pupils progress from supported, structured paragraphs to independent, multi-causal essays evaluating 'significance' and 'change over time'.
- **Causation:** Transitions from identifying simple triggers to categorizing long-term vs. short-term causes (e.g., the complex alliance systems and naval race of 1914).

3. Diversity, Equity & Representation

We are committed to delivering a curriculum that de-centers traditional anglocentric narratives, elevating the voices of the marginalized and giving pupils a truly global perspective.

- **Indigenous Perspectives:** The History of Australia unit critically examines the impact of British settlement on Indigenous peoples, moving beyond the traditional 'discovery' narrative.
- **Enslaved Voices:** The Early Modern World unit focuses on the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and actively highlights how enslaved Africans resisted.
- **The 'Ordinary' Voice:** The Industrialisation unit explores how ordinary working-class people, rather than just monarchs, fought for a voice and the expansion of democracy.
- **The Forgotten Armies:** The Great War unit deliberately questions how much of a 'World' war it was by uncovering the forgotten contributions of the Empire's troops.
- **Experiential Learning (Ypres Trip):** The upcoming Year 9 Battlefields Trip to Ypres provides an invaluable opportunity for pupils to walk the ground of the Great War, cementing their classroom learning with powerful lived experience.

4. Pedagogical Strengths (SEND & Accessibility)

The integrated use of the Meoncross School History Department app alongside printed A4 workbooks and textbooks is deliberately designed to provide maximum support for SEND pupils:

- **Cognitive Offloading:** The combination of guided workbooks directly matched to structured digital tasks significantly reduces working memory strain, allowing pupils to focus entirely on historical thinking.
- **Dual Coding & Scaffolding:** The app utilizes consistent visual layouts, dual-coded images for vocabulary, and highly structured scaffolding (like sentence starters and PEEL frameworks) to support pupils with dyslexia or processing needs.
- **Multimodal Engagement:** By seamlessly transitioning between interactive digital tasks and focused reading from printed textbooks, the curriculum caters to diverse

learning profiles while preventing screen fatigue.

5. Substantive Concept Mapping

In line with modern KS3 history pedagogy, we actively track and weave substantive concepts ("big ideas" like Empire, Religion, and Power) across different periods. Rather than teaching these as isolated definitions, pupils build complex mental schemas by encountering them in varied contexts—from the power of the Medieval Church, through to the ideological clashes of the Cold War.

6. "Worldbuilding" & Cultural Literacy

Before pupils can effectively tackle abstract disciplinary concepts (such as causation or source utility), they require a rich "picture of the past". Our curriculum deliberately immerses pupils in the sensory and lived experiences of historical periods—such as daily life in a medieval village or the harsh realities of a WW1 trench—ensuring a secure cultural and chronological grounding prior to high-level analysis.

KS₃: The Shoah

Year 9 | How did a modern, civilized nation commit the systematic murder of six million Jewish people?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
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Unit in Development – Content TBC

KS3: The Cold War

Year 9 | Why did the ideological clash between Capitalism and Communism bring the world to the brink of nuclear destruction?

Lesson Number &
Title

Learning Objectives

Core Assessment & Tasks

Unit in Development – Content TBC

KS3: The Second World War (1939–1945)

Year 9 | What was the decisive turning point of the Second World War?

Lesson Number &
Title

Learning Objectives

Core Assessment & Tasks

Unit in Development – Content TBC

KS3: Rights, Protest, and Post-War Britain (1900–Present)

Year 9 | How has British identity transformed since 1945?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Votes for Women: Were the Suffragists or Suffragettes more effective in securing the vote?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 1945: How did the aftermath of total war build the Welfare State and the NHS?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 3 The Windrush Generation: Why did Britain invite Commonwealth citizens, and what did they face?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 4 The 1963 Bristol Bus Boycott & the fight for British civil rights.	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 The Cold War on the Home Front: How did nuclear paranoia shape British popular culture?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 6 Assessment: How has British identity transformed since 1945?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>